

daVIPA colour system

Vision · Planning · Action



Version 1.0 · 20 August 2026

Derived from the crimson app icon artwork (1254 × 1254 px)

Eight core colours · 88 ramp steps · three gradients

Provenance and method

Every colour in this document was measured from one source file: the crimson daVIPA app icon. Nothing was chosen by eye or carried over from another document. This section records how, so the numbers can be reproduced or challenged.

What was sampled

Three structures in the artwork carry colour, and each was sampled differently. The **circle and square strokes** are a flat fill; their colour is the median of all 57,810 strongly red-dominant pixels, giving `#DE1B24`. The **arrow** is a continuous gradient, sampled at nine evenly spaced points along its 45° axis from tail to tip. The **tile** and the **canvas behind it** are also gradients, sampled at their corners and edge midpoints, clear of the strokes and the arrow.

How the ramps were built

Each core colour was converted to CIELCh (D65, 2° observer). Ramp steps hold the base hue angle constant and move lightness to fixed targets (L* 97 at step 50 down to L* 9 at step 950), with chroma reduced as the step moves away from the base and then clipped to the sRGB gamut by binary search. The brand colour itself occupies whichever step is nearest its own lightness, exactly and unmodified — so each ramp contains the real colour rather than an approximation of it.

Two honest limits. First, this palette is an extraction, not a decision: it describes what the artwork contains. Where a colour is called “primary” or “accent” below, that is a proposal based on how much area it occupies and what it does in the mark, not a rule you have set. Second, the CMYK values are unprofiled mathematical conversions. Do not send them to print — a printer working to a specific stock and profile should convert from the sRGB values instead.

Core palette

Eight colours. Two neutrals establish the dark ground, two structural colours build surfaces, and four accents carry emphasis. Values are sRGB.

Crimson
PRIMARY
	`#DE1B24`
	`rgb(222, 27, 36)`
	`hsl(357, 78%, 49%)`
		CMYK `0, 88, 84, 13`
		L* `47.6` C `84.4` h `34.4°`
		ramp step `600`
			The circle and square strokes. Carries the mark; use for the logo strokes, primary calls to action and single points of emphasis.

Indigo
SECONDARY
	`#2E1C8F`
	`rgb(46, 28, 143)`
	`hsl(249, 67%, 34%)`
		CMYK `68, 80, 0, 44`
		L* `21.6` C `73.4` h `305.4°`
		ramp step `900`
			Upper-left of the icon tile. The brand's structural colour: large surfaces, headers, filled panels.

Violet
SUPPORTING
	`#813389`
	`rgb(129, 51, 137)`
	`hsl(294, 46%, 37%)`
		CMYK `6, 63, 0, 46`
		L* `35.7` C `56.4` h `324.6°`
		ramp step `700`
			Mid-right of the tile, where indigo turns toward magenta. Bridges indigo and magenta; secondary surfaces and hover states.

Magenta
ACCENT
	`#D051C1`
	`rgb(208, 81, 193)`
	`hsl(307, 57%, 57%)`
		CMYK `0, 61, 7, 18`
		L* `55.2` C `72.0` h `331.4°`
		ramp step `500`
			Arrow tail. The cool end of the arrow gradient; charts, tags, decorative accents.

Coral
ACCENT
	`#F55161`
	`rgb(245, 81, 97)`
	`hsl(354, 89%, 64%)`
		CMYK `0, 67, 60, 4`
		L* `58.2` C `68.7` h `22.9°`
		ramp step `500`
			Arrow midpoint. Warm mid-tone, closest neighbour to Crimson - keep the two apart.

Amber
ACCENT
	#FD924A
	rgb(253, 146, 74)
	hsl(24, 98%, 64%)
		CMYK 0, 42, 71, 1
		L* 70.8 C 64.4 h 57.4°
		ramp step 300
			Arrow tip and the tile's upper-right glow. Highlights, warm emphasis, gradient terminus.

Midnight NEUTRAL	#171447 rgb(23, 20, 71) hsl(244, 56%, 18%)	CMYK 68, 72, 0, 72 L* 10.1 C 37.0 h 301.6° ramp step 950	The canvas the tile sits on. Default dark background.
Deep ink NEUTRAL	#101342 rgb(16, 19, 66) hsl(236, 61%, 16%)	CMYK 76, 71, 0, 74 L* 8.7 C 34.6 h 299.1° ramp step 950	Lower-left of the tile, the darkest measured value. Deepest background, dark-mode base.

Tint and shade ramps

Eleven steps per colour. The step marked beneath is the brand colour itself; every other step is generated. Steps 50–200 are backgrounds and fills, 300–500 are illustrative mid-tones, 600–700 are borders and text on light backgrounds, 800–950 are dark surfaces.

Crimson

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFF4F2	#FFE5E1	#FFC7BD	#FFA090	#FF7260	#F43E37	#DE1B24	#B20016	#86000E	#5D0000	#350B00

brand colour

Indigo

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#F9F5FF	#F0E7FF	#DFCCFF	#C7AAFF	#AD8BF9	#9170E0	#7859CA	#5E42B4	#40299C	#2E1C8F	#000365

brand colour

Violet

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFF3FF	#FFE2FF	#FCC1FF	#E99FED	#CE83D3	#B368B9	#9C4FA2	#813389	#691E71	#4E0157	#330039

brand colour

Magenta

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFF3FC	#FFE3F9	#FFC1F4	#FF93EF	#EA6FDA	#D051C1	#B339A6	#97208C	#78006E	#52004B	#360031

brand colour

Coral

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFF4F4	#FFE5E4	#FFC7C5	#FF9E9E	#FF6F77	#F55161	#CB3046	#AD1233	#850023	#5C0015	#3D0005

brand colour

Amber

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#FFF4EF	#FFE6D8	#FFC9A9	#FD924A	#EA833E	#C96A28	#AC5515	#8F4000	#6B2F00	#461F00	#2A1400

brand colour

Midnight

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#F8F5FF	#EEE8FF	#DACDFF	#BEB1E5	#A396CB	#897CB2	#71659B	#5A4F85	#42386D	#292256	#171447

brand colour

Deep ink

50	100	200	300	400	500	600	700	800	900	950
#F7F5FF	#EDE8FF	#D7CEFE	#BCB3E3	#A098C9	#867DAF	#6E6799	#575183	#3F3A6B	#262454	#101342

brand colour

Gradients

The icon uses no flat brand surfaces beyond the strokes — both the arrow and the tile are continuous gradients. These are the measured stops.

Arrow gradient

Measured along the arrow axis, tail to tip. Sampled at nine points; these three are the endpoints and midpoint.

```
background: linear-gradient(135deg, #D051C1, #F55161, #FD924A);
```

Tile gradient



The icon tile, sampled bottom-left to top-right across four positions.

```
background: linear-gradient(45deg, #101342, #2E1C8F, #813798, #FD915B);
```

Ground gradient



The canvas behind the tile, corner to corner.

```
background: linear-gradient(160deg, #100F47, #291E68);
```

Contrast and accessibility

WCAG 2.1 contrast ratios, computed from relative luminance. Thresholds: 4.5:1 for normal text (AA), 3:1 for large text and user-interface components, 7:1 for AAA. Ratings below are for **normal-size text**.

Colour	on white		on Midnight		on Deep ink		white on it	
Crimson	4.90	AA	3.49	fail	3.59	fail	4.90	AA
Indigo	12.51	AAA	1.37	fail	1.41	fail	12.51	AAA
Violet	7.59	AAA	2.26	fail	2.32	fail	7.59	AAA
Magenta	3.73	fail	4.59	AA	4.71	AA	3.73	fail
Coral	3.37	fail	5.08	AA	5.22	AA	3.37	fail
Amber	2.24	fail	7.65	AAA	7.86	AAA	2.24	fail
Midnight	17.11	AAA	1.00	fail	1.03	fail	17.11	AAA
Deep ink	17.59	AAA	1.03	fail	1.00	fail	17.59	AAA

What this means in practice. Crimson clears AA on white for body text but only just, and it fails on both dark grounds — on Midnight it reaches 3.49:1, enough for large headings and icon strokes but not for paragraphs. Amber and Coral fail against white entirely and should never carry small text there; they work as fills with dark text on top, or as text on the dark grounds, where Amber reaches 7.65:1. Indigo is the only accent that is comfortable as text on white at 12.51:1, and it is unusable on the dark grounds at 1.37:1. White text is safe on Crimson, Indigo, Violet and both neutrals, and unsafe on Amber.

Usage

Do

Let one accent lead per surface. The arrow gradient already spans magenta to amber. Adding a second unrelated accent alongside it produces six competing hues in one view.

Use the neutrals as the default ground. The identity was designed dark; Midnight and Deep ink are what the accents were sampled against and what they are calibrated to sit on.

Take text colours from the 700–950 steps on light backgrounds, and 50–300 on dark. The base colours themselves are mostly mid-lightness and marginal for small text.

Reserve Crimson for the mark and for genuine emphasis. It is the only colour in the system that reads as a signal rather than a surface.

Don't

Don't place Crimson next to Coral. They sit 11° apart in hue (34.4° and 22.9°) and read as a printing error rather than a deliberate pairing.

Don't set body text in Amber or Coral on white. Both fail AA at 2.24:1 and 3.37:1.

Don't rebuild the gradients by eye. Use the stops on the previous page; the arrow gradient in particular passes through a specific coral midpoint that a two-stop approximation misses.

Don't treat this palette as compatible with the original steel-blue logo. The two share no colour. If both must appear, one has to be restated in the other's terms.

Developer tokens

Core colours as CSS custom properties. Full ramps follow the same pattern, `--davipa-{name}-{step}`.

```
:root {
  --davipa-crimson: #DE1B24;
  --davipa-indigo: #2E1C8F;
  --davipa-violet: #813389;
  --davipa-magenta: #D051C1;
  --davipa-coral: #F55161;
  --davipa-amber: #FD924A;
  --davipa-midnight: #171447;
  --davipa-deep-ink: #101342;
  --davipa-gradient-arrow: linear-gradient(135deg, #D051C1, #F55161, #FD924A);
  --davipa-gradient-tile: linear-gradient(45deg, #101342, #2E1C8F, #813798, #FD915B);
  --davipa-gradient-ground: linear-gradient(160deg, #100F47, #291E68);
}
```